

The Monthly Newsletter — Plan & Review Kit

Prepared for review with Aleksandra · Draft for discussion, not yet approved to send

This document gives you three editorial **outlines** to choose from, an **operations & maintenance** plan for running the newsletter every month, and a walkthrough of the three **design layouts** included in this kit. Nothing here is live or sent — it is all for you and Aleksandra to review, mark up and approve.

1 · My recommendation on the fraud / trust angle

Short answer: **yes — and it can become your single strongest differentiator**, provided we frame it the right way. Hospice fraud is a real, documented problem, and Los Angeles County was at the center of it. Because your brand is built on **Compliance-Led Care**, you are uniquely positioned to talk about it — not as an accusation, but as protection for families.

How to do it safely and powerfully

- **Educate, don't accuse.** Frame it as “how to recognize a *legitimate* hospice.” Give families red flags and a way to verify any provider. This empowers the reader instead of scaring them.
- **Never name or imply a specific competitor.** Naming a company as fraudulent — even indirectly — is a legal (defamation) risk. Speak about the pattern, not the players.
- **Cite public authorities only.** The California State Auditor's findings and the state's decision to pause new hospice licensing (beginning 2022) are on the public record. Attribute facts to them; avoid statistics you cannot source.
- **Don't over-claim.** Avoid “most hospices are frauds” or fear-based language. Let your credentials (Medicare-Certified · CDPH-Licensed · ACHC-Accredited) be the quiet reassurance.
- **Anti-Kickback awareness.** When this goes to referral partners, keep the message about *quality and integrity*, never inducements.

Bottom line: done as consumer education, this builds trust, protects families, and quietly proves you are the opposite of the bad actors. That is exactly the reputation that grows census and makes the company attractive to a future buyer.

2 · Three outlines to choose from

Each is a complete monthly format with a different center of gravity. You can pick one, or rotate them (e.g. the Trust issue quarterly, Care & Comfort in between). I've mapped each to one of the three layouts, but any outline works in any layout.

OUTLINE A

“The Trust Issue” — Compliance-Led / Consumer Protection

Audience: Families, community, and referral partners · **Tone:** Steady, protective, authoritative · **Pairs with:** Layout 3 (Spotlight)

1. **Masthead + one-line mission** — “Care That Honors Life.”
2. **Feature:** “How to Know a Hospice You Can Trust” — the fraud story framed as family protection: what happened in California/LA, and the red flags to watch for.
3. **The 60-second checklist** — how any family can verify a hospice (license, Medicare certification, accreditation, 24/7 access, written plan of care).
4. **Why it matters at Eternal Life** — a short, non-boastful note tying to the Compliance-Led Care pillar.
5. **One comfort note** — a brief, warm item so the issue isn't all serious (e.g. an integrative-comfort tip).
6. **Call to action** — “Questions about hospice? Talk to a nurse, 24/7.” + refer link.

OUTLINE B

“Care & Comfort” — Warm, Family-Facing

Audience: Families & community · **Tone:** Gentle, human, reassuring · **Pairs with:** Layout 1 (Editorial)

1. **A note from the team** — 3–4 warm sentences setting the season's theme.
2. **Feature story** — drawn from the Journal (e.g. Music at the Bedside, Sound Baths, Caring for the Caregiver).
3. **Comfort tip of the month** — one practical, doable idea for caregivers.
4. **Resource spotlight** — the Family Guide, or a coverage/insurance explainer.
5. **Community & gratitude** — volunteers, giving, or a partner thank-you (with the standard non-affiliation note where needed).
6. **Call to action** — read the Journal / reach a nurse / volunteer.

“The Referral Partner Briefing” — For Case Managers & Physicians

Audience: Discharge planners, case managers, physicians · **Tone:** Concise, professional, useful · **Pairs with:** Layout 2 (Digest)

1. **Header + “refer in 60 seconds” button** up top.
2. **What sets our care apart this month** — one clinical or service capability (e.g. GIP, integrative comfort, rapid response).
3. **Compliance & quality note** — credentials, response times, the integrity message (this is where the trust theme lives for partners).
4. **Coverage snapshot** — Ventura + LA County, settings served.
5. **Quick resource for their patients** — a family-facing link they can pass along.
6. **Direct line** — name, phone, fax, secure referral link.

3 · Ongoing operations & maintenance

A newsletter only builds trust if it arrives *reliably*. Here is a simple, repeatable operating rhythm so it never becomes a scramble.

Monthly cadence & roles

STEP	WHO	WHEN
Pick the issue theme & feature	Team lead	~3 weeks before send
Draft the copy (reuse a layout)	Writer	~2 weeks before
Compliance & accuracy review (see checklist)	Aleksandra / clinical sign-off	~1 week before
Final approval	Aleksandra	2–3 days before
Load, test-send, schedule	Sender	Send day
Review results, file the issue	Team lead	Week after

Suggested rhythm: same day each month (e.g. the second Tuesday, ~10am). Predictability improves open rates and keeps the workload calm.

Sending platform

Use a proper email service (not personal Gmail) so you get consent tracking, unsubscribe handling and deliverability. **MailerLite** or **Brevo** are cost-friendly and a good fit; both have free tiers to start.

*Avoid platforms built for e-commerce. Keep **no patient health information (PHI)** in any newsletter — that keeps you clear of HIPAA exposure.*

List & consent hygiene

- Only email people who opted in or are legitimate business contacts.
- Segment two lists: **Families/Community** and **Referral Partners**.
- Every send needs a working **unsubscribe** link and your **physical mailing address** (CAN-SPAM law).
- Honor unsubscribes immediately; never buy lists.

Design maintenance

- Keep the three layouts as reusable templates — each month you only swap the words and one image, not the design.
- Store the master files in `exports/newsletter/` and save each sent issue as `issue-YYYY-MM.html` so you build an archive.
- Stay on-brand: plum, gold and cream; Fraunces headlines, Jost body; the infinity lockup at the top.

Measuring success

Track three numbers only: **list growth**, **open rate**, and **click rate** (which links get tapped). Healthy healthcare-newsletter benchmarks are roughly 30–40% opens and 2–5% clicks; use them as a compass, not a grade.

Suggested first three issues

MONTH	THEME	FEATURE
Issue 01	Trust (Outline A)	How to know a hospice you can trust
Issue 02	Comfort (Outline B)	Small comforts: music & sound at the bedside
Issue 03	Partners (Outline C)	Refer with confidence — our compliance posture

4 · The three layouts in this kit

Open each file to see the full design; each is filled with sample “Issue 01” content so you can picture the real thing. All three print cleanly on standard paper.

Layout 1 — Editorial

Elegant, single-column magazine feel. Serif hero, a feature story, and a sidebar of quick links. Best for the warm Care & Comfort issues.

File: layout-1-editorial.html

Layout 2 — Digest

Compact and scannable — short stacked blocks with clear headings. Built for busy referral partners.

File: layout-2-digest.html

Layout 3 — Spotlight

One bold feature takes the whole top of the page, followed by a slim checklist and a call-to-action strip. Built for the Trust issue — it gives the fraud/protection story the room it deserves.

File: layout-3-spotlight.html

5 · Compliance checklist (run before every send)

Every medical/therapy mention framed as **comfort & quality of life** — no claims to diagnose, treat, cure or prevent.

Any Medicare statement is accurate (covered in full with no hospice-benefit deductible; small possible costs only for some comfort meds / inpatient respite).

No competitor named or implied; fraud facts attributed to public authorities only.

No patient health information (PHI) anywhere in the issue.

Referral-partner content speaks to quality/integrity, never inducements (Anti-Kickback / Stark).

Working unsubscribe link + physical mailing address present (CAN-SPAM).

Coverage stated as Ventura & Los Angeles County only.

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This is an internal planning draft prepared for review. Content, statistics and framing must complete the compliance checklist above and receive final approval before any distribution. References to hospice fraud describe publicly reported findings by state authorities and are presented for consumer education only; they do not describe or refer to any specific provider.